

Cybersecurity Daily Newsletter

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Top 5 Highlights

- Android malware combo takes out loans and relays victims' credit cards
- Akira ransomware attacker uses Safe Mode reboot to evade EDR
- Thailand plans mandatory multi-factor authentication after massive data leak
- Uber Freight investigating data security incident after Helix claims breach
- Colombia's Ministry of Justice hit by ransomware attack

Threat Intelligence (10)

01. Android malware combo takes out loans and relays victims' credit cards

A new Android NFC relay malware called WindRelay is being used alongside the SpyNote remote administration tool (RAT) to steal live card data and send it to attackers in real time. [...]

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/android-malware-combo-takes-out-loans-and-relays-victims-credit-cards/>

02. LiteLLM supply chain attack impacted over 2,500 organizations

The compromise of LiteLLM, a Python library and proxy server, occurred indirectly.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Audit build pipelines, rotate CI/CD secrets, enforce package integrity controls, and review developer workstation hardening.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/litellm-supply-chain-attack-impacted-over-2500-organizations>

03. Lazarus hackers pair fake job offers with Windows zero-day exploit

The North Korea-linked Lazarus group is using fake job offers, trojanized PDF software and a Windows zero-day in attacks aimed primarily at the defense sector, Check Point researchers have found. The activity is part of Operation Dream Job, a long-running campaign in which attackers pose as recruiters and lure targets with job opportunities at well-known co...

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Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/08/12/north-korea-lazarus-fake-job-offers/>

04. Fake CCleaner downloads turn Chrome into a credential-stealing surveillance tool

A convincing fake version of the widely used CCleaner utility is being used to deliver a multi-stage Windows malware that ultimately abuses Google Chrome for credential theft and surveillance. Researchers from Malwarebytes found the campaign distributing a malicious Chrome extension called GhostDesk, which can capture credentials, cookies, keystrokes, and s...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.csoononline.com/article/4208565/fake-ccleaner-downloads-turn-chrome-into-a-credential-stealing-surveillance-tool.html>

05. Brit rail cops bring live facial recognition to the London Underground

Victoria is the first stop as privacy campaigners warn the technology is becoming routine

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/security/2026/08/12/brit-rail-cops-bring-live-facial-recognition-to-the-london-underground/5286697>

06. [+24h Old] Over 2,500 Organizations Impacted by LiteLLM Supply Chain Attack

LiteLLM was compromised through the Trivy hack and abused to distribute information-stealing malware to its users. The post Over 2,500 Organizations Impacted by LiteLLM Supply Chain Attack appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Audit build pipelines, rotate CI/CD secrets, enforce package integrity controls, and review developer workstation hardening.

Sources:

<https://www.securityweek.com/over-2500-organizations-impacted-by-litellm-supply-chain-attack/>

07. [+24h Old] The AI harness is the new attack surface

Ask a security researcher what makes an AI agent dangerous, and the instinct is to talk about the model - what it will and won't refuse, how easily it can be jailbroken, whether its weights can be trusted. That instinct is increasingly out of date. A growing body of security research - exploit demonstrations, independent red-teaming, and assessments by secu...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Audit build pipelines, rotate CI/CD secrets, enforce package integrity controls, and review developer workstation hardening.

Sources: <https://www.csoononline.com/article/4208236/the-ai-harness-is-the-new-attack-surface.html>

08. [+24h Old] Malicious LiteLLM Releases Tied to Trivy Hack May Have Exposed 2,100+ Organizations

Two malicious LiteLLM releases sat on PyPI for about 40 minutes in March carrying credential-stealing code capable of harvesting cloud keys, SSH keys, Kubernetes tokens, database passwords, and other secrets from systems that installed them. Threat intelligence firm CloudSEK now says a dataset it obtained, built from roughly 434,000 files

the attackers capt...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/08/malicious-litellm-releases-tied-to.html>

09. [+24h Old] ISC Stormcast For Wednesday, August 12th, 2026

<https://isc.sans.edu/podcastdetail/10048>, (Wed, Aug 12th)

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Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://isc.sans.edu/diary/rss/33238>

10. [+24h Old] Sandworm hackers target IT pros with trojanized WireGuard VPN client

Hackers associated with the Russian threat group Sandworm have been targeting system administrators and IT professionals through fake job offers since at least May. [...]

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/sandworm-hackers-target-it-pros-with-trojanized-wireguard-vpn-client/>

Latest Vulnerabilities (10)

01. New 'Plug and Pwn' attacks exploit Windows Plug and Play for SYSTEM privileges

Security researchers Alejandro Hernando and Borja Martínez demonstrated attacks at DEF CON 34 that exploit Windows' automatic hardware identification and driver installation process.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/new-plug-and-pwn-attacks-exploit-windows-plug-and-play-for-system-privileges>

02. Long-running Data Theft Campaign Targeting Salesforce, ServiceNow

The "City-Forum" campaign has been active since at least March 2025 and has targeted organizations across multiple sectors with custom tooling.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/cyberattacks-data-breaches/long-running-data-theft-campaign-salesforce-servicenow>

03. Researcher creates workaround for Microsoft Defender security patch

Just weeks after Microsoft patched a critical hole in Microsoft Defender, a cybersecurity researcher has posted an apparent workaround that provides system-level control to attackers once they gain any level of access. The researcher, who goes by the name Nightmare Eclipse, has been engaged in a long-running battle with Microsoft Security...

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Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.csoonline.com/article/4208760/researcher-creates-workaround-for-microsoft-defender-security-patch.html>

04. Hackers exploit critical Adobe Commerce flaw to hijack customer accounts

Attempts to exploit a critical vulnerability (CVE-2026-71362) in Adobe's Commerce and Magento e-commerce platforms have been detected, potentially allowing attackers to hijack customer accounts. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/hackers-exploit-critical-adobe-commerce-flaw-to-hijack-customer-accounts/>

05. Critical VMware vCenter flaw actively exploited in 47 countries

Unspecified APT group has made attacks across 361 unique IP addresses in 47 countries.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/news/critical-vmware-vcenter-flaw-actively-exploited-in-47-countries>

06. The vulnerability flood is here. Here's what it means - and how to prepare

We can't control the pace of AI-driven vulnerability discovery, but we can control how fast we respond.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources:

<https://www.scworld.com/native/the-vulnerability-flood-is-here-heres-what-it-means-and-how-to-prepare>

07. Lazarus Exploits Windows Zero-Day to Gain SYSTEM Access and Deploy Backdoor

The North Korean threat actor known as Lazarus Group has been attributed to the zero-day exploitation of a newly patched security flaw impacting Microsoft Windows to deliver a never-before-seen backdoor targeting defense and aerospace companies across France, Germany, Brazil, and India. The activity, per Check Point Research, is part of Operation Dream Job,...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/08/lazarus-exploits-windows-zero-day-to.html>

08. Lazarus hackers exploited Windows zero-day to target defense firms

North Korean hackers have been exploiting a Windows zero-day vulnerability (CVE-2026-68820) to target defense-sector companies as part of the Operation Dream Job campaign. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/lazarus-hackers-exploited-windows-zero-day-to-target-defense-firms/>

09. SharePoint Vulnerability Exploited Shortly After PoC Release

The vulnerability was patched by Microsoft in July and CISA warned that it could end up being exploited in the wild. The post SharePoint Vulnerability Exploited Shortly After PoC Release appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.securityweek.com/sharepoint-vulnerability-exploited-shortly-after-poc-release/>

10. 737 Chrome VPN Extensions Caught Routing Traffic Through Proxies. Check If You Have One

A massive set of 737 free VPN and proxy extensions have been found to mainly target Russian-speaking users seeking access to blocked services with an aim to intercept browser traffic and route them through a proxy infrastructure. The extensions, published across at least 40 Chrome Web Store developer accounts, racked up 75,486 installs. Of those identified,...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/08/737-chrome-vpn-extensions-caught.html>

Data Breach & Cybercrime (10)

01. Akira ransomware attacker uses Safe Mode reboot to evade EDR

The ransomware payload ultimately failed to deploy due to insufficient virtual memory.

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources:

<https://www.scworld.com/news/akira-ransomware-attacker-uses-safe-mode-reboot-to-evade-edr>

02. Thailand plans mandatory multi-factor authentication after massive data leak

The Digital Economy and Society Minister is seeking cabinet approval for compulsory multi-factor authentication across all government systems.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/thailand-plans-mandatory-multi-factor-authentication-after-massive-data-leak>

03. Uber Freight investigating data security incident after Helix claims breach

The incident at Uber Freight, the logistics arm of the ride-sharing giant, comes after the Helix group listed the company on its data leak site on August 6, claiming to have accessed mailboxes, OneDrive accounts, and accounts receivable.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources:

<https://www.scworld.com/brief/uber-freight-investigating-data-security-incident-after-helix-claims-breach>

04. Colombia's Ministry of Justice hit by ransomware attack

The attack, which impacted services related to illicit-drug monitoring and legal processes, followed a warning from Colombia's national CERT about increased ransomware group focus on the country.

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/colombias-ministry-of-justice-hit-by-ransomware-attack>

05. Uber Freight keeps on trucking after extortion crew breaks in

Helix claims nearly a million files, while the logistics biz says operations never hit the brakes

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/security/2026/08/12/uber-freight-keeps-on-trucking-after-extortion-crew-breaks-in/5286782>

06. WindRelay Malware Pairs With SpyNote RAT in Live-Call Scam

New WindRelay NFC malware paired with SpyNote RAT let a fraudster clone a card mid-call

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/windrelay-nfc-relay-spynote-rat/>

07. Ransomware Hits Colombian Justice Ministry Days Before Presidential Transition

Attackers continue to target critical infrastructure and government-linked organizations in the country, mirroring the increased activity across Latin America.

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/cyberattacks-data-breaches/ransomware-hits-colombian-justice-ministry-presidential-transition>

08. Exposed: Woeful security at UK criminal records office that led to sensitive data leak

Nobody patched the CMS or read the alerts, and ACRO still cannot tell whether info was exfiltrated

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/security/2026/08/12/exposed-woeful-security-at-uk-criminal-records-office-that-led-to-sensitive-data-leak/5286736>

09. WhatsApp Unveils New Scam Alert Feature

Signal has also made a security announcement: an automatic key verification feature to complement its safety number system. The post WhatsApp Unveils New Scam Alert Feature appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.securityweek.com/whatsapp-unveils-new-scam-alert-feature/>

10. Akira ransomware scum blocked victim's security tools - and broke their own encryptor

Gives a whole new meaning to Safe Mode

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/research/2026/08/12/akira-ransomware-scum-blocked-victims-security-tools-and-broke-their-own-encryptor/5286515>